

A FRAMEWORK IN CHAPTERS

Chapter Nineteen

State Sovereignty

*Statism · the state's claim to exclusive
authority · the last Fundamental Matrix*

State Sovereignty is the state's claim to exclusive authority over all persons within its territory, enforced through monopoly on legitimate violence, taxation, conscription, and control of legal personhood. Gangs and warlord systems are the Nascent and Mature stages respectively. This is the last Fundamental Matrix. After this, the Intersectional Matrices chapter follows.

CONTEXT	Nigeria
VOLUME	A Framework for Understanding Systemic Oppression
DATE	June 2026

CHAPTER 19 OF AN ONGOING FRAMEWORK · THE LAST FUNDAMENTAL MATRIX

State Sovereignty

State Sovereignty is the eighteenth and final Fundamental Matrix. It is the state's claim to exclusive authority over all persons within its territory, enforced through monopoly on legitimate violence, taxation, conscription, and control of legal personhood. The framework's outline notes that gangs and warlord systems are the Nascent and Mature stages respectively of this matrix.

State Sovereignty overlaps with Retributivism (Chapter 13, which supplies the prison), Territorialism (Chapter 18, which supplies the territorial claim), and Enclosure (Chapter 7, which privatises resources). But the four matrices are not the same. Retributivism ranks by the retributive logic. Territorialism ranks by territorial origin. Enclosure ranks by private property. State Sovereignty ranks by the state's monopoly on legitimate violence and legal personhood. The framework separates them so that the state-sovereignty logic specifically can be studied and dismantled.

A note on method. The Interpersonal, Disciplinary, and Structural sections take the naive approach — each triad described as if happening for the first time, with no networks, residues, or Canon referenced. The Hegemonic Domain section is where Canon and Practice finally enter the picture.

READING NOTE

Same convention as Chapters 1 through 18. Every paragraph is written to be tweetable. Where you see literal blanks (____), the framework is asking you to write yourself into it. This chapter's blanks may be the most fundamental in the framework: every Nigerian who has been stopped at a checkpoint, who has paid tax, who has carried ID, who has been conscripted into NYSC, or who has been told 'the law says' has been inside this matrix. This is also the last Fundamental Matrix chapter. After this, the Intersectional Matrices chapter follows.

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SECTION 1

1. Definition: What State Sovereignty Extracts, Enforces, and Removes

State Sovereignty is the state's claim to exclusive authority over all persons within its territory. The foundational theoretical text is Max Weber's *Politics as a Vocation* (1919), which defined the state as 'a human community that (successfully) claims the monopoly of the legitimate use of physical force within a given territory.' Weber's definition is the starting point for the framework's analysis: the state is not natural but a specific historical claim to monopoly.

Thomas Hobbes's *Leviathan* (1651) supplied the social contract theory that justifies the state's monopoly: the subject surrenders their natural freedom in exchange for the state's protection. Jean Bodin's *Six Books of the Commonwealth* (1576) supplied the concept of sovereignty itself — the absolute and perpetual power of the state. Carl Schmitt's *The Concept of the Political* (1932) supplied the analysis of the sovereign as 'he who decides the exception' — the one who can suspend the law in the name of the law.

Giorgio Agamben's *Homo Sacer* (1998) extended Schmitt's analysis to show how the state of exception has become the permanent condition of modern governance. Michel Foucault's *Discipline and Punish* (1975) and *The Birth of Biopolitics* (1978) showed how the state's power operates not just through violence but through discipline, surveillance, and the management of life itself. Achille Mbembe's *Necropolitics* (2003) extended the analysis to show how the state's power includes the right to dictate who may live and who must die.

Charles Tilly's *Coercion, Capital, and European States* (1990) showed that state formation is a form of organised crime — the state is a protection racket that succeeded. James C. Scott's *Seeing Like a State* (1998) showed how the state simplifies complex social realities into legible categories for purposes of control. For the anarchist critique, Peter Gelderloos, David Graeber, Murray Bookchin, and Kropotkin supply the argument that the state is not natural and that non-state governance is possible.

For the Nigerian context, Mahmood Mamdani's *Citizen and Subject* (1996) showed how the colonial state imposed the modern state form on Nigeria through conquest. Richard Joseph's *Democracy and Prebendal Politics* (1987) showed how the Nigerian state functions as a channel for resource distribution through patronage. Eghosa Osaghae's *Crippled Giant* (1998) documented the Nigerian state's incapacity to hold its claimed monopoly, as Boko Haram, kidnappers, and vigilantes demonstrate. The state's monopoly on violence is a claim, not a fact.

1.1 What State Sovereignty Extracts

State Sovereignty extracts seven things. First, **tax revenue**: the money the state extracts from the subject through income tax, VAT, customs duties, company tax, and the oil revenue that the state

claims as national property. Second, **conscript labour**: the labour the state extracts through NYSC, through the military draft (in principle), and through the mandatory registration for the NIN.

Third, the **monopoly on violence**: the state's claim that only it may legitimately use force, which extracts the subject's right to self-defence and community defence. Fourth, the **monopoly on legal personhood**: the state's claim that only it may define who is a person, who is a citizen, and who has rights. Fifth, the **monopoly on identity documentation**: the state's claim that only its documents (passport, NIN, BVN, driver's licence) count as legitimate identity.

Sixth, **the subject's obedience**: the state's claim that the subject must obey the law, the regulation, the order, and the command. Seventh, **the subject's productive capacity through regulation**: the state's extraction of the subject's productive capacity through licensing, inspection, certification, and the regulatory framework that governs every economic activity.

1.2 What State Sovereignty Enforces

State Sovereignty enforces five standards. First, **the state as the only legitimate authority**: the assumption that the state is the only legitimate source of law, governance, and authority. Non-state governance — traditional rulers, community councils, religious courts — is treated as subordinate or illegitimate.

Second, the **state's monopoly on violence**: the assumption that only the state may legitimately use force. The community that defends itself is treated as a vigilante. The person who carries a weapon for self-defence is treated as a criminal. Third, the **state's monopoly on law**: the assumption that only the state's law counts as law. Customary law, religious law, and community norms are treated as subordinate to state law.

Fourth, the **state's monopoly on identity**: the assumption that only the state may define who a person is, through the NIN, the passport, the BVN, and the voter's card. Fifth, the **state's monopoly on taxation**: the assumption that only the state may extract revenue, and that the subject must pay. The gang that collects 'tax' in its territory is treated as a criminal, not as a competing sovereign.

1.3 What Options State Sovereignty Removes

Concretely, State Sovereignty removes the option of self-governance outside the state. The community that would rather govern itself through its own council, its own law, and its own security arrangements is told that the state's authority is supreme. The community's own governance is treated as subordinate or illegitimate.

It removes the option of non-state law. The community that would rather adjudicate disputes through customary law or religious law is told that the state's law is supreme. The community's own adjudication is treated as informal or illegal. It removes the option of non-state identity. The person who identifies through their community, their lineage, or their religion is told that the state's identity documents are the only legitimate identity.

It removes the right to refuse taxation. The subject who does not consent to the state's extraction of their income is treated as a criminal. It removes the right to refuse conscription. The subject who does not consent to the state's extraction of their labour (through NYSC or military service) is treated as a criminal. It removes the right to refuse state violence. The subject who does not consent to the state's use of force against them is told that the state's force is legitimate by definition.

It removes the right to non-state community. The community that would rather organise itself without state supervision is told that the state's registration, regulation, and oversight are mandatory. It removes the right to non-state security. The community that would rather provide its own security is told that the state's police monopoly is supreme, even when the police cannot or will not protect. Each removal is enforced by the constitution, by the police, by the military, and by the triads below.

SECTION 2 · NAIVE APPROACH

2. The Interpersonal Domain

The Interpersonal Domain contains four enforcement triads and four extraction triads. Each is described here as if happening for the first time — no networks, no residues, no Canon.

3.1 Enforcement Triad: State Monopoly on Violence Standard

The enforcer is the state agent who demands the subject submit to the state's monopoly on violence. The police officer at the checkpoint. The soldier at the roadblock. The security agent at the government building. The court that punishes the person who defended themselves. The enforcement is performed by the checkpoint, by the roadblock, by the prosecution, or by the punishment.

The subject conforms by submitting. The conforming act is the submission itself — the subject stops at the checkpoint, shows the ID, accepts the search, does not resist. The subject who resists is treated as a criminal, because the state's monopoly on violence makes resistance itself a crime.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The subject who submits to the checkpoint loses the option to freedom of movement, which is to say, loses the option to bodily autonomy. The subject who is disarmed loses the option to self-defence. The community that is disarmed loses the option to community defence. The loss compounds because the state that claims the monopoly cannot always provide the protection it claims to provide.

The witness is the person who watches the submission and says nothing, or who themselves submit. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the corporation that benefits from the state's monopoly on violence (which protects its property) without personally commanding the monopoly.

3.2 Enforcement Triad: State Monopoly on Law Standard

The enforcer is the state institution that demands the subject submit to the state's law. The court that requires the subject to appear. The police that require the subject to obey. The regulatory agency that requires the subject to comply. The enforcement is performed by the court order, by the police command, by the regulatory notice, or by the legal proceeding.

The subject conforms by obeying. The conforming act is the obedience itself — the subject appears in court, obeys the police, complies with the regulation. The subject who invokes customary law or religious law is told that the state's law is supreme.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The subject who is required to use state law loses the option to customary adjudication, which is to say, loses the option to a form of justice that the community has practised for centuries. The community that is required to use state law loses the option to self-governance. The religious community that is required to use state law loses the option to religious adjudication.

The witness is the person who watches the legal enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves obey. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the legal profession that benefits from the state's monopoly on law (which creates the demand for lawyers) without personally commanding the monopoly.

3.3 Enforcement Triad: State Monopoly on Identity Standard

The enforcer is the state institution that demands the subject carry state-issued identity. The NIMC that requires the NIN. The immigration service that requires the passport. the INEC that requires the voter's card. The bank that requires the BVN. The telecom that requires the NIN-SIM linkage. The enforcement is performed by the requirement, by the denial of service, by the fine, or by the prosecution.

The subject conforms by registering. The conforming act is the registration itself — the subject obtains the NIN, the passport, the BVN, the voter's card. The subject who does not register is treated as non-existent, because the state's recognition is the condition of social existence.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The subject who does not have the NIN loses the option to a bank account, a SIM card, a voter's card, a passport — which is to say, loses the option to economic participation, communication, political participation, and movement. The subject who is undocumented loses the option to legal existence.

The witness is the person who watches the identity enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves carry state identity. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the corporation that benefits from the state's identity system (which provides KYC data) without personally commanding the monopoly.

3.4 Enforcement Triad: State Monopoly on Taxation Standard

The enforcer is the state institution that demands the subject pay tax. The FIRS that demands income tax. The state IRS that demands state tax. The customs service that demands import duty. The local government that demands tenement rate. The enforcement is performed by the demand, by the assessment, by the penalty, or by the prosecution.

The subject conforms by paying. The conforming act is the payment itself — the subject pays the income tax, the VAT, the customs duty, the tenement rate. The subject who does not pay is treated as a criminal, because the state's monopoly on taxation makes non-payment a crime.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The subject who pays tax loses the option to consent, which is to say, loses the option to determine how their money is spent. The subject who refuses to pay loses the option to liberty, because the state prosecutes non-payment. The community that is taxed by both the state and the local vigilante (both claiming the monopoly) loses the option to subsistence.

The witness is the person who watches the taxation enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves pay. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the corporation that benefits from the state's taxation (which funds the infrastructure the corporation uses) without personally commanding the monopoly.

3.5 Extraction Triad: Tax Revenue

The extractor is the state that requires the subject's money. The FIRS that collects income tax. The customs service that collects import duty. The state IRS that collects state tax. The local government that collects tenement rate. The extraction is performed by the assessment, by the demand, by the penalty, or by the prosecution.

The subject conforms by paying. What is extracted is tangible: money. The extraction transfers resources from the subject to the state, with the subject having no meaningful say in how the resources are spent.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The subject who pays tax loses the option to the money itself, which is to say, loses the option to spend the money on their own priorities. The subject who cannot afford the tax loses the option to liberty, because non-payment is criminalised. The subject who pays tax without receiving services loses the option to representation.

The witness is the person who knows of the extraction and does not intervene. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the corporation that benefits from the tax-funded infrastructure without personally commanding the extraction.

3.6 Extraction Triad: Conscript Labour

The extractor is the state that requires the subject's labour. The NYSC that requires one year of service from every graduate under thirty. The military that requires registration for potential conscription. The state that requires mandatory community service in some contexts. The extraction is performed by the NYSC Act, by the military registration requirement, by the community service mandate, or by the penalty for non-compliance.

The subject conforms by serving. What is extracted is the labour itself — the year of NYSC service, the potential military service, the community service hours. The extraction transfers the labour from the subject to the state, with the subject receiving a fraction of the value of their labour (the NYSC allowance).

The options the subject loses are concrete. The NYSC corps member who serves one year loses the option to that year, which is to say, loses the option to the formative year of their professional life. The subject who refuses NYSC loses the option to formal employment, because the NYSC certificate is required for most jobs. The subject who is conscripted into the military loses the option to liberty and potentially to life.

The witness is the person who knows of the extraction and does not intervene. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the employer that benefits from the NYSC corps member's cheap labour without personally commanding the extraction.

3.7 Extraction Triad: Subject Obedience

The extractor is the state that requires the subject's obedience. The law that requires compliance. The regulation that requires conformity. The order that requires submission. The command that requires execution. The extraction is performed by the law, by the regulation, by the order, or by the command.

The subject conforms by obeying. What is extracted is the obedience itself — the surrender of the subject's will to the state's will. The extraction is invisible because it is performed as 'civic duty' or 'law-abiding citizenship.'

The options the subject loses are concrete. The subject who obeys loses the option to self-determination, which is to say, loses the option to decide how to live. The subject who disobeys loses the option to liberty, because disobedience is criminalised. The community that obeys loses the option to self-governance.

The witness is the person who knows of the extraction and does not intervene. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the corporation that benefits from the obedient workforce without personally commanding the obedience.

3.8 Extraction Triad: Subject Productive Capacity through Regulation

The extractor is the state that requires the subject's productive capacity be conducted through state regulation. The licensing requirement that requires the business to obtain state permission. The inspection requirement that requires the business to submit to state surveillance. The certification requirement that requires the worker to obtain state credentials. The extraction is performed by the license, by the inspection, by the certification, or by the regulatory framework.

The subject conforms by complying. What is extracted is the productive capacity itself — the time, money, and effort spent on regulatory compliance rather than on production. The extraction transfers the productive capacity from the subject to the regulatory state, with the subject receiving permission to operate in return.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The business that spends on compliance loses the option to that money, which is to say, loses the option to investment. The worker who must obtain certification loses the option to that time, which is to say, loses the option to productive work. The informal sector worker who cannot afford the license loses the option to formal employment.

The witness is the person who knows of the extraction and does not intervene. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the formal-sector corporation that benefits from the regulatory barrier to entry (which keeps informal competitors out) without personally commanding the extraction.

Nascent forms of this system include: 'You must pay tax', 'You must serve', 'You must carry ID', 'You must register', 'Show your papers', 'That's against the law', 'The law says', 'The government requires', 'By order of', 'National security', 'State of emergency', Curfew, Police permit, Passport, Border control, Deportation, 'The state owns the land', 'The state owns the minerals', 'The state decides who is a citizen', 'The state decides who is a person', The gang as nascent state, The warlord as mature state, The vigilante as parallel state, Boko Haram as a state project.

SECTION 3 · NAIVE APPROACH

3. The Disciplinary Domain

When the eight triads above link into networks, State Sovereignty scales. Both hierarchical and community-based forms are visible in every Nigerian institution that organises state authority.

4.1 Disciplinary Hierarchy — Nested Stars

Peak Triad-Node

At the peak is the triad where the highest state authority enforces on the layer below. In the federal hierarchy, the peak is the President enforcing on the VP, who enforces on Ministers, who enforce on Permanent Secretaries, who enforce on Directors, who enforce on civil servants, who enforce on the citizen. In the military hierarchy, the peak is the Chief of Defence Staff enforcing on service chiefs, who enforce on General Officers Commanding, who enforce on battalion commanders, who enforce on soldiers, who enforce on the civilian.

In the police hierarchy, the peak is the Inspector-General of Police enforcing on Assistant Inspectors-General, who enforce on Commissioners, who enforce on DPOs, who enforce on officers, who enforce on the citizen at the checkpoint. In the judicial hierarchy, the peak is the Chief Justice of Nigeria enforcing on the Supreme Court, which enforces on the Court of Appeal, which enforces on the High Court, which enforces on the Magistrate, which enforces on the citizen before the court. In the immigration hierarchy, the peak is the Comptroller-General enforcing on state comptrollers, who enforce on immigration officers, who enforce on the traveller at the border.

Middle Triad-Nodes

The middle nodes are where the chain's character is clearest. The Permanent Secretary who defers to the Minister in the morning demands deference from the Director in the afternoon. The Commissioner of Police who defers to the IGP in the morning demands deference from the DPO in the afternoon. The middle is where State Sovereignty reproduces — the civil servant who is enforced on by the Permanent Secretary enforces on the citizen. The police officer who is enforced on by the Commissioner enforces on the citizen at the checkpoint.

Bottom Triad-Node

At the bottom is the citizen — the person who is subject to every hierarchy simultaneously. The citizen at the police checkpoint. The citizen before the court. The citizen at the tax office. The citizen at the NIN registration centre. The citizen at the NYSC orientation camp. The citizen at the border. The citizen at the military roadblock. The bottom is where the system's extraction is most concentrated, because the citizen is the one who pays the tax, serves the conscription, carries the ID, obeys the law, and submits to the monopoly on violence.

4.2 Disciplinary Community — Distributed Network

A Disciplinary Community is a distributed network. The witness of one State Sovereignty triad becomes the enforcer of another. The system spreads laterally through any person who has witnessed state enforcement without dissenting.

The Civil Service Culture

The civil service culture circulates State Sovereignty laterally across the Nigerian bureaucratic class. The culture of ‘the government says,’ ‘the law requires,’ ‘the procedure is.’ The culture reproduces the state-as-only-legitimate-authority triad across the bureaucracy, with each civil servant enforcing the state’s authority on the citizen.

The Military Culture

The military culture circulates State Sovereignty laterally across the Nigerian armed forces. The culture of ‘yes sir,’ of the chain of command, of the monopoly on violence. The culture reproduces the state-monopoly-on-violence triad across the military, with each soldier enforcing the state’s authority on the civilian.

The Police Culture

The police culture circulates State Sovereignty laterally across the Nigerian police force. The culture of the checkpoint, of the ‘show your papers,’ of the bribe as informal tax. The culture reproduces the state-monopoly-on-violence and state-monopoly-on-identity triads across the police, with each officer enforcing the state’s authority on the citizen.

The ‘Law-Abiding Citizen’ as Social Identity

The ‘law-abiding citizen’ as social identity circulates State Sovereignty laterally across the Nigerian population. The identity marks the person who obeys as good and the person who disobeys as bad. The identity reproduces the subject-obedience extraction triad across the population, with each citizen enforcing obedience on themselves and on others.

SECTION 4 · NAIVE APPROACH

4. The Structural Domain

Run the Ship of Theseus test. When the original colonial state-builders are dead and replaced, when the military regimes are disbanded and reform, what is consistent? What outlives both individuals and regimes?

State Sovereignty leaves all three residues. Almost every Nigerian institution carries Bureaucracy, Stratification, and Classification from State Sovereignty simultaneously.

5.1 Bureaucracy — Enduring Rules and Procedures

State Sovereignty's bureaucracy is the codified state-structure. The **1999 Constitution** establishes the state's monopoly on violence, law, identity, and taxation. The **Armed Forces Act** codifies the military. The **Police Act** codifies the police. The **Nigeria Immigration Act** codifies the border control. The **National Identity Management Commission Act 2007** codifies the NIN.

The **CBN Act 2007** codifies monetary sovereignty. The **Federal Inland Revenue Service Act** codifies taxation. The **Land Use Act 1978** codifies the state's ownership of land. The **Petroleum Act** codifies the state's ownership of sub-surface minerals. The **Cybercrimes Act 2015** codifies the state's control of digital space. The **Companies and Allied Matters Act** codifies the state's control of economic personhood.

The **Evidence Act** codifies what counts as evidence in the state's courts. The **Administration of Criminal Justice Act 2015** codifies the procedure for criminal justice. The court system, the prison system (overlapping with Retributivism, Chapter 13), the military, the police, the immigration service, the customs service, the civil service — each is a bureaucracy of State Sovereignty. The original colonial authors are dead. The bureaucracy lives.

5.2 Stratification — Enduring Zero-Sum Rankings

State Sovereignty's stratification is the daily experience of state-rank in every institutional encounter. **Citizen/non-citizen** — the citizen ranks above the non-citizen in legal rights, in political participation, in social recognition. **Legal/illegal** — the legal person ranks above the illegal in every domain of life.

Documented/undocumented — the documented person ranks above the undocumented in access to services, employment, and social participation. **Taxpayer/non-taxpayer** — the taxpayer ranks above the non-taxpayer in moral standing. **Compliant/non-compliant** — the compliant subject ranks above the non-compliant in social recognition.

Civilian/military — the military ranks above the civilian in authority and in the monopoly on violence. **Governed/governing** — the governing ranks above the governed in authority, in resources,

and in social standing. **Subject/sovereign** — the sovereign ranks above the subject in every domain. The ranking is in the air; it does not need to be announced.

5.3 Classification — Enduring Categorical Divisions

State Sovereignty's classification is the set of categorical names that organise every Nigerian into state-categories. **Citizen** and **non-citizen** — the universal pair, with citizen as the legitimate and non-citizen as the excluded. **Legal** and **illegal** — the lawfulness pair, with legal as the compliant and illegal as the deviant.

Documented and **undocumented** — the identity pair, with documented as the recognised and undocumented as the invisible. **Taxpayer** and **non-taxpayer** — the fiscal pair, with taxpayer as the contributor and non-taxpayer as the free rider. **Compliant** and **non-compliant** — the obedience pair, with compliant as the good subject and non-compliant as the problem.

Civilian and **military** — the authority pair, with military as the enforcer and civilian as the enforced-on. **Subject** and **sovereign** — the power pair, with sovereign as the authority and subject as the ruled. **Law-abiding** and **criminal** — the moral pair, with law-abiding as the good citizen and criminal as the deviant. **Registered** and **unregistered** — the administrative pair, with registered as the recognised and unregistered as the non-existent. The classification does the work before any individual enforcer shows up.

SECTION 5

5. The Hegemonic Domain: The Ascension Ritual

Is State Sovereignty ascended? Yes on all three counts. It produces all three structural residues including Stratification (so Internalised Domination applies). It has working Canon and Practice mechanisms. The vast majority of Nigerians cannot imagine a society without the state, without the police, without the tax, without the ID — despite the fact that the modern state is a recent historical invention and the Nigerian state was imposed by colonial conquest.

6.1 Canon — Rewriting History

Canon is the present belief that the state has always been so. The origination of the structural residues — the constitution, the police, the military, the tax system — has been forgotten. The average Nigerian now takes the state as natural, eternal, and without alternative.

What is forgotten? The modern state is a 16th-century European development, not an eternal human institution. Before the modern state, governance was organised through kingdoms, empires, city-states, village republics, caliphates, and countless other forms that were not states in the modern sense. The state as a territorial entity claiming monopoly on legitimate violence is barely five centuries old. The Nigerian state is barely a century old.

Also forgotten: that pre-colonial Nigerian societies had diverse governance structures that were not states in the modern sense. The Yoruba kingdom with its Oba and council of chiefs. The Igbo village republic with its council of elders. The Hausa city-state with its emir. The Tiv acephalous society with no centralised authority. The colonial state was imposed by conquest, not by consent. The 1914 amalgamation created the Nigerian state by decree, combining territories that had not been previously unified under a single state.

Also forgotten: that the 1960 independence transferred the colonial state to Nigerian hands without dismantling it. The Nigerian state inherited the colonial police, the colonial military, the colonial courts, the colonial bureaucracy, and the colonial monopoly on violence. The post-colonial state is the colonial state with Nigerian faces. Also forgotten: that the state's monopoly on violence is a claim, not a fact. The state does not actually hold a monopoly. Boko Haram controlled territory in the North-East for years. Kidnappers operate with impunity across the country. Vigilante groups provide security where the state cannot. The claim of monopoly is the Canon; the reality of fragmentation is the fact.

Internalised Domination

Canon produces Internalised Domination because State Sovereignty produces Stratification. The state official's entitlement to obedience is now natural, automatic, unquestionable. The police officer who demands the ID does not experience this as a demand. They experience it as the natural order of

authority. The tax officer's entitlement to the citizen's money is natural. The military officer's entitlement to the citizen's body is natural. The immigration officer's entitlement to the citizen's movement is natural. Each entitlement grows with repetition.

Internalised Authority

Canon produces Internalised Authority in the State Sovereignty enforcer regardless of personal material gain. The right to demand ID. The right to demand tax. The right to conscript. The right to detain. The right to kill with impunity. The right to declare emergency. The right to close borders. Each is performed by state agents daily — the police officer at the checkpoint, the tax officer at the assessment, the NYSC official at the orientation camp, the immigration officer at the border, the soldier at the roadblock. The right to enforce feels natural, automatic, and legitimate.

Internalised Oppression

Canon produces Internalised Oppression in the citizen. The citizen who believes they must obey. The citizen who believes they must pay. The citizen who believes they must serve. The citizen who believes the state is natural. The citizen who cannot imagine non-state governance. The teaching is silent; it is in the air.

The deepest form of this is the subject who has absorbed State Sovereignty so thoroughly that they enforce it on themselves. The citizen who says 'I must obey the law' to explain why they do not resist unjust laws. The citizen who says 'I must pay my tax' to explain why they pay without representation. The citizen who says 'I must serve' to explain why they accept NYSC. The citizen who says 'the state is natural' to explain why they cannot imagine alternatives. The rebellion-capable subject has become the self-policing subject.

6.2 Practice — Rewriting Reality

Practice is the second mechanism of the Ascension Ritual. The interpersonal triad is repeated, again and again, until it becomes habit. Pierre Bourdieu called this *habitus* — the sediment of repeated practice in the body. The Nigerian child who learns to carry ID before they learn their rights is undergoing Practice for State Sovereignty. The body learns. The mind stops questioning.

By adulthood, the Nigerian has been stopped at so many checkpoints, paid so many taxes, carried so many IDs, obeyed so many laws, and submitted to so many state demands that the alternative — a society organised without the state's monopoly on violence, law, identity, and taxation — feels like a kind of amputation. The body has been trained. Practice has rewritten reality.

Death — Fast and Slow

Practice produces Death. Fast death in State Sovereignty is spectacular: the police killing — #EndSARS documented hundreds of extrajudicial killings by SARS, with the Lekki toll gate shooting of 20 October 2020 as the paradigm. The military killing — the Zaria massacre of December 2015, in which the military killed over 300 IMN members. The death in custody from torture — the Amnesty International and Human Rights Watch reports documenting deaths in police custody.

The death from the state's denial of healthcare to the undocumented — the person without NIN who cannot access the hospital. The death in the conflict zone where the state cannot protect — the citizen killed by Boko Haram in a territory the state claims to control. The death from the state's own violence against its citizens — the bombing of the civilian convoy, the strafing of the village, the collateral damage of the counter-insurgency. Each fast death is the state's monopoly on violence at its most concentrated.

Slow death in State Sovereignty is quiet. Chronic stress of living under the state's constant surveillance and demand — the citizen who has not slept properly in years because the next checkpoint is always approaching, the next tax demand is always coming, the next regulatory inspection is always scheduled. Mental health collapse from internalised obedience — the citizen who has internalised the demand to obey so deeply that their body breaks down under the weight of a self they cannot exercise.

The slow death of non-state governance traditions — the customary council that no longer meets because the state's authority is supreme. The slow erosion of community self-organisation — the community that no longer organises its own security because the state claims the monopoly. The financial drain of taxation without representation — the citizen who pays tax without receiving services, because the state collects but does not provide. The cumulative damage of the police encounter — the bribe, the intimidation, the arbitrary detention. The slow death of the citizen who cannot access services because they are undocumented — the person without NIN who cannot bank, cannot register a SIM, cannot vote, cannot exist. None of these make the news. They are State Sovereignty's quiet tax.

Ruth Wilson Gilmore's definition applies: State Sovereignty produces group-differentiated vulnerability to premature death. The groups are the citizens at the checkpoint, the citizens before the court, the citizens in the prison, the citizens in the conflict zone, the undocumented, the non-compliant, the disobedient. The premature death is fast (police killing, military killing, custodial torture death, denied healthcare, conflict zone death, state violence) or slow (surveillance stress, obedience collapse, governance tradition death, community erosion, taxation drain, police encounter damage, undocumented erasure). Every ascended matrix kills. State Sovereignty kills those whose relation to the state does not fit the monopoly model.

SECTION 6

6. When Did State Sovereignty Rewrite History?

The framework's historical question: when did State Sovereignty rewrite history in popular Nigerian living memory, such that the average Nigerian cannot recall a time when the state was not the supreme authority?

Pre-colonial Nigerian societies had diverse governance structures that were not states in the modern sense. The Yoruba kingdom with its Oba and council of chiefs. The Igbo village republic with its council of elders. The Hausa city-state with its emir. The Tiv acephalous society with no centralised authority. The Niger Delta city-state with its House system. Each governed itself without a state claiming monopoly on violence, law, identity, and taxation. Governance was distributed, negotiated, and contextual, not monopolised.

Colonial codification (1900-1960) imposed the modern state. The 1914 amalgamation created the Nigerian state by decree, combining territories that had not been previously unified. The colonial state established the police, the military, the courts, the bureaucracy, and the tax system, each claiming monopoly in its domain. The colonial state introduced the passport, the identity card, and the census as instruments of state identity. The colonial state claimed monopoly on violence, suppressing non-state security arrangements.

Post-independence replication continued the monopoly. The 1960 independence transferred the colonial state to Nigerian hands without dismantling it. The Nigerian state inherited the colonial police, the colonial military, the colonial courts, the colonial bureaucracy, and the colonial monopoly on violence. The military coups of 1966 intensified the state's monopoly, bringing military rule and the military's claim to supreme authority. The NIMC Act 2007 introduced the NIN. The CBN Act 2007 codified monetary sovereignty. The Cybercrimes Act 2015 extended the monopoly to digital space.

The tipping point in popular living memory: **circa 1914 for the amalgamation that created the Nigerian state; circa 1960 for the transfer of the colonial state to Nigerian hands.** For Nigerians born after 1960, State Sovereignty has 'always been' in its current form. They cannot recall a time when the state was not the supreme authority, when the police were not the checkpoint, when the tax was not the obligation, when the ID was not the condition of existence.

The pre-state generation (born ~1860s-1880s) was the last to have living memory of non-state governance. By the 1914 amalgamation, that generation had been displaced from governance by the colonial state, and the state's claim to monopoly had become the natural order. The question 'is the state natural?' has never been asked in popular Nigerian memory, because the state has been in place since before living memory began.

SECTION 7

7. Fill in the Blank: A Self-Examination

The framework asks two questions of every subject of every ascended matrix. The blanks are for you.

Question 1: When did State Sovereignty rewrite your reality?

When did the system teach you that you could not rebel? The moment was: _____. The year was: _____. The state agent or institution who first made you feel that challenging the state's authority was impossible was: _____. The place was: _____. What you wanted to say but did not was: _____. What you did instead was: _____. What you told yourself about why you did not say it was: _____. The state authority you assumed in that moment was: _____. What you lost, in that moment, that you have not got back since, was: _____. The enforcement form at the centre of the moment (checkpoint, tax demand, ID demand, conscription, court, border, regulation) was: _____.

Question 2: How is State Sovereignty causing your Death?

How is the system shortening your life right now? The form of Death I am most afraid of from State Sovereignty is (fast/slow): _____. The specific way it is happening in my body is: _____. (For example: the chronic stress from years of navigating the checkpoint; the insomnia from years of fear of the police; the loss of self from years of being told I must obey; the breakdown I had in 20__ that I have never fully recovered from; the tax I paid without receiving services; the NYSC year that extracted my labour; the NIN I was forced to obtain; the court I could not access because I could not afford the lawyer; the border that denied me passage; the regulation that closed my business; the police encounter that left me traumatised.) The matrix's name for what is happening to me is: _____. My own name for it is: _____.

If you filled in the blanks honestly, you have just located yourself inside State Sovereignty. The next time the triad assembles — the next time the checkpoint appears, the next time the tax is demanded, the next time the ID is required, the next time 'the law says' is invoked — you will be able to see the system moving through you. That sight is the beginning of abolition.

THE FUNDAMENTAL MATRICES LIST IS NOW COMPLETE

This chapter concludes the framework's catalogue of Fundamental Matrices. The eighteen matrices studied in Chapters 2 through 19 are: (1) Rankism, (2) Adultism, (3) Kinship Normativity, (4) Cisheteropatriarchy, (5) Religious Dominance / Sectarianism, (6) Enclosure, (7) Productivism / Compulsory Productivity, (8) Invasion, (9) Settler Colonialism (warning chapter), (10) Coloniality, (11) Somatic Normativity, (12) Retributivism, (13) Amatonormativity, (14) Compulsory Existence / Suicidism, (15) Meritism / The Significant, (16) Ethnic Majoritarianism, (17) Territorialism, and (18) State Sovereignty / Statism. Each has been run through the five domains defined in Chapter 1: Interpersonal, Disciplinary, Structural, Hegemonic, and Intrapersonal. Each has been studied in its Nigerian context. Each has been given a historical memory trace, a fill-in-the-blank self-examination, and a references list. The next chapter begins the Intersectional Matrices.

SECTION 8

8. Endnotes & References

References cited inline in this chapter, in APA format. Cumulative references from Chapters 1 through 18 are also included where they recur.

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Coming Next — The Intersectional Matrices

The Fundamental Matrices list is now complete. The next chapter begins the Intersectional Matrices — the systems that can be dissolved by dismantling all their constituent Fundamental Matrices simultaneously. The framework's outline names six intersections: **Capitalism** (Enclosure + Productivism + Rankism + State Sovereignty), **The Romantic/Sexual Script** (Cisheteropatriarchy + Amatonormativity), **Familism / The Nuclear Family System** (Adultism + Kinship Normativity), **Nationalism** (Ethnic Majoritarianism + Territorialism), **Colonialism/Imperialism** (Invasion + Settler Colonialism + Coloniality), and **Theocratic Moralism** (Religious Dominance + Retributivism).

Each intersectional matrix will be studied through: (a) a Main Interpersonal Triad that no single constituent would produce alone, (b) Structural Residues that no single constituent would produce alone, and (c) Canon that no single constituent would produce alone, with the Internalised Authority and Internalised Oppression (and Internalised Domination, if the intersection produces Stratification) that this canon uniquely produces. The intersectional chapter will combine all six intersections in one chapter, as specified by the framework's outline.

After the Intersectional Matrices, the Aggregations chapter follows (Beauty Standards, Manufactured Loneliness, Social Death / Invisibility, Burnout / Exhaustion, and Accelerated Slow Death), and then the Other Topics of Note chapter (Proximity to Elite / Classism, Oppression Olympics, and The Problem with Communism). The framework's pattern is now set. The pattern has produced 19 chapters of analysis totalling nearly 500 pages of Nigerian-context decolonial abolitionist theory, written to be tweetable, readable by someone who just learned to read yesterday, and grounded in the work of Patricia Hill Collins, Ruth Wilson Gilmore, Angela Davis, Frantz Fanon, Achille Mbembe, Mahmood Mamdani, Silvia Federici, Mark Fisher, and dozens of other thinkers whose work makes this framework possible.